

Verified Revenue, Not Vanity Metrics

What 1,000 real, payment-verified startups reveal about where value concentrates in the builder economy

1,000

Companies Tracked

100%

Payment-Verified

29

Categories

65

Countries

A New Asset Class Is Emerging — Hiding in Plain Sight

- 1,000 small, founder-led software businesses — tracked with revenue confirmed directly by payment processors, not self-reported.
- Combined tracked MRR of \$13.47M — but the distribution is extremely long-tailed.
- Median company MRR is just \$282, while the mean is \$13,472 — a small number of large winners pull the average far above the typical business.

\$13.47M

Total MRR Tracked

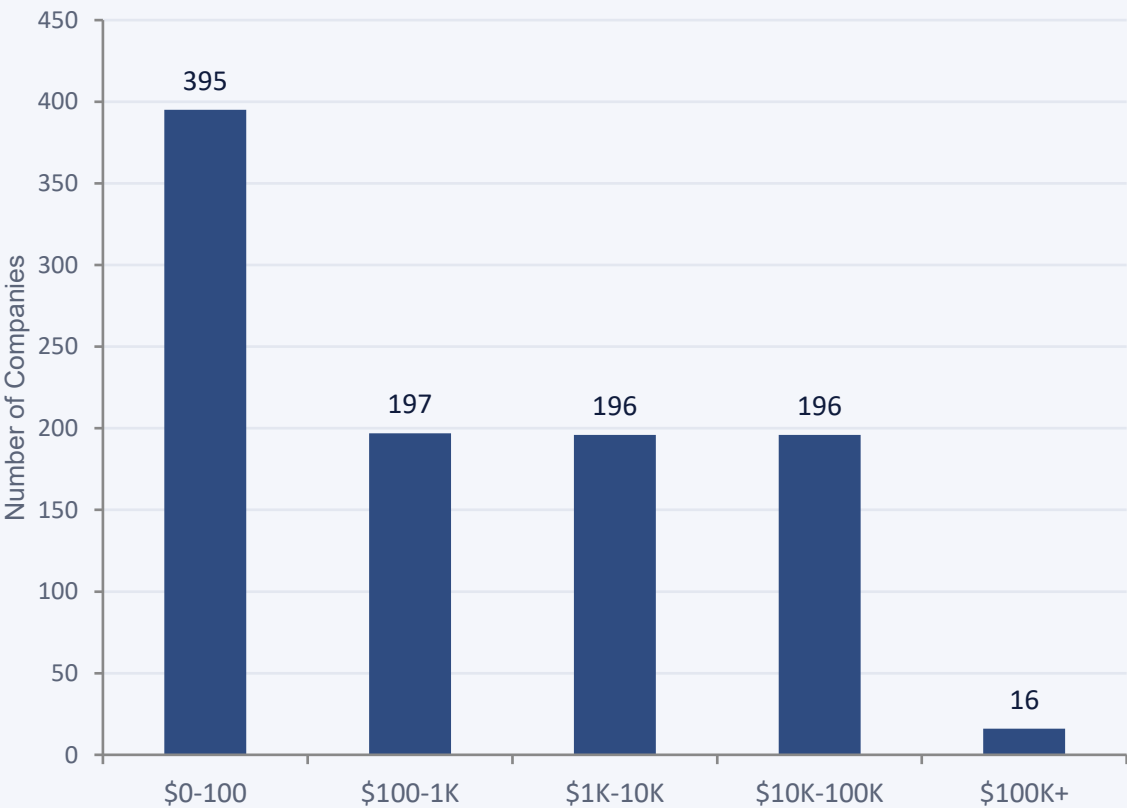
\$282

Median Company MRR

\$13,472

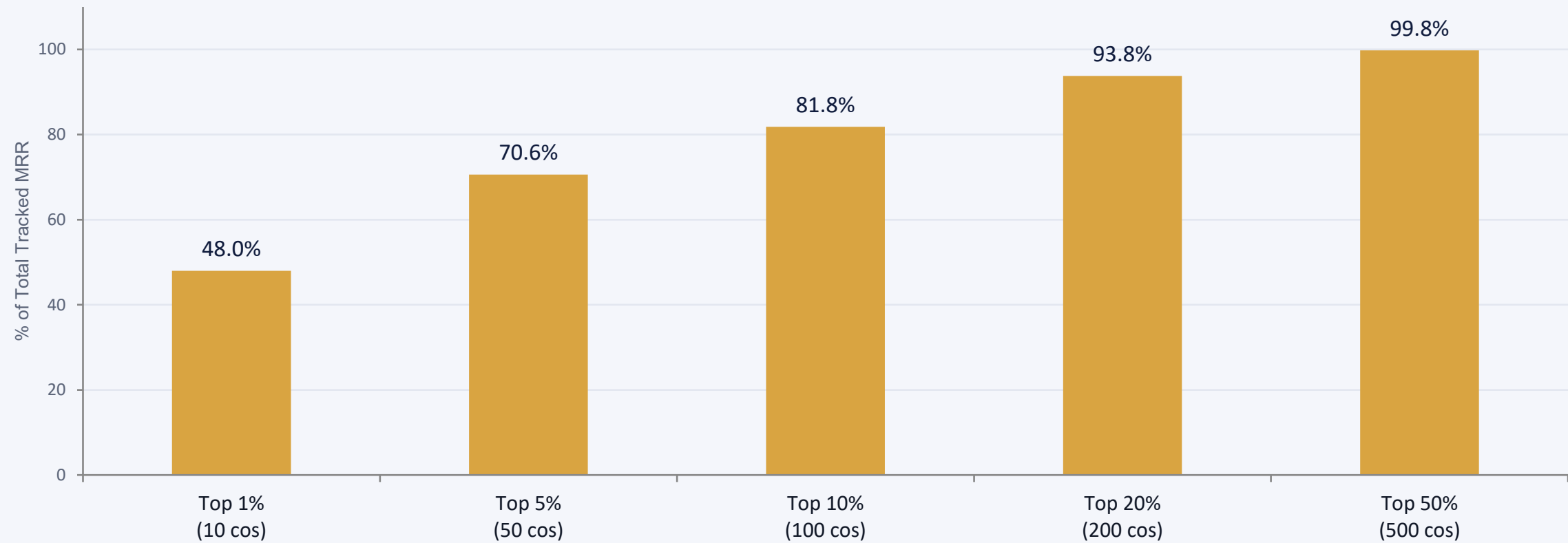
Mean Company MRR

Company Count by Monthly Revenue Band



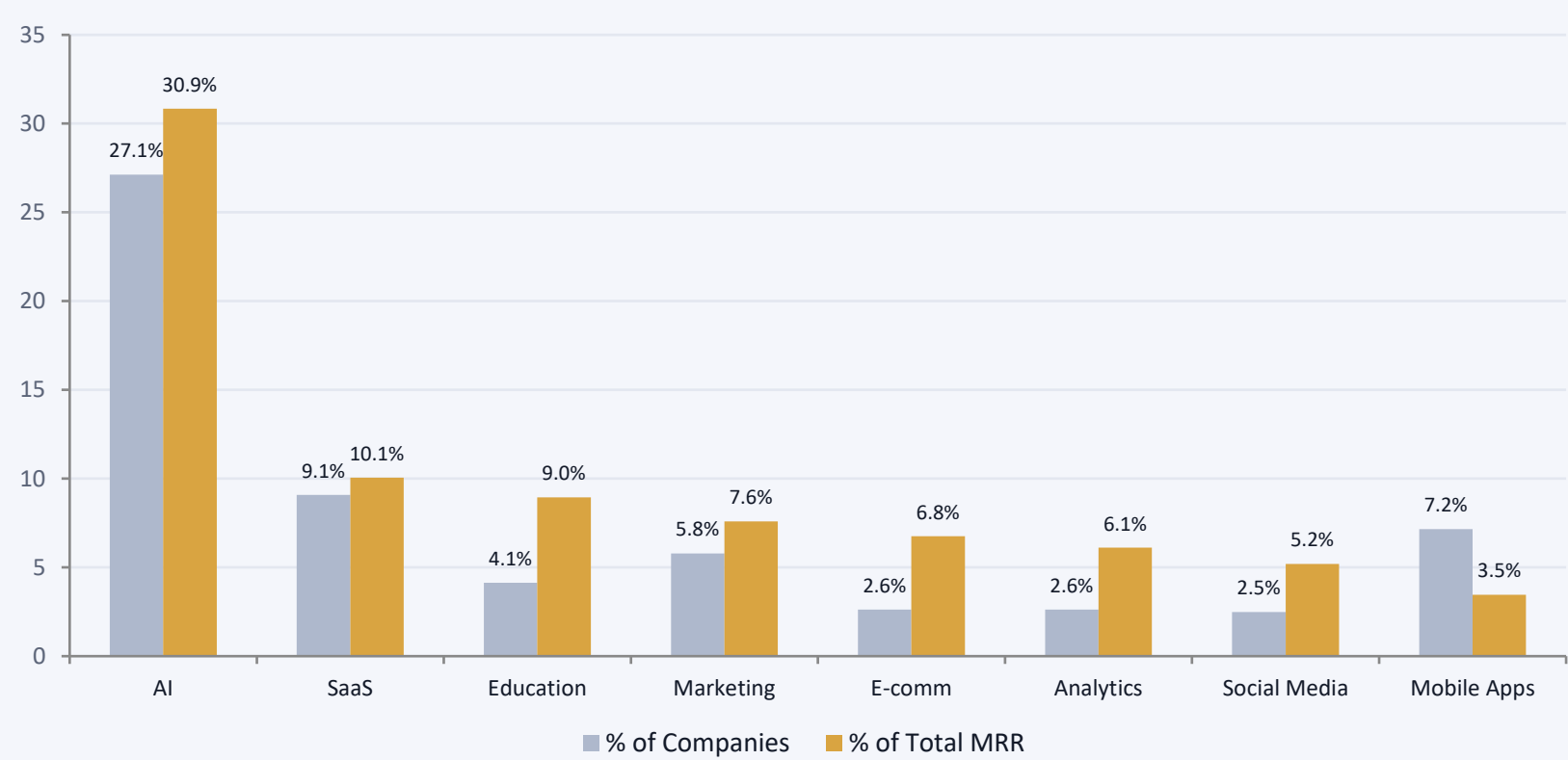
10 Companies Capture Nearly Half of All Tracked Revenue

The market is a power law, not a bell curve — economic value concentrates fast at the very top.



Bigger Isn't Better: The Most Crowded Category Monetizes Worst

AI is the largest category by company count (27.1% of categorized companies), yet its median company earns just \$446/mo — near the bottom of all categories.



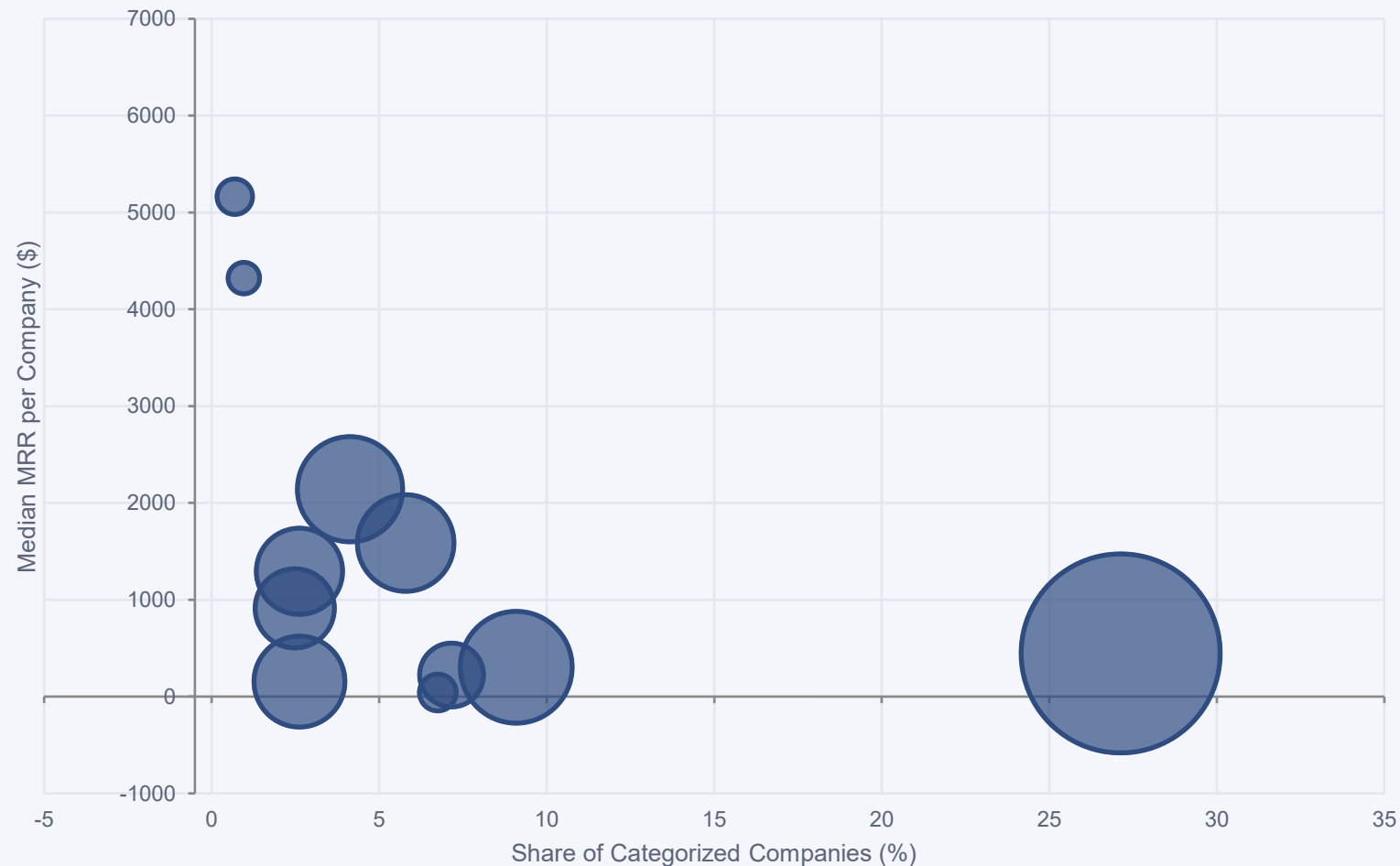
\$446

Median MRR for an AI company — 91% below Customer Support's \$5,163 median

197

AI companies in this snapshot — the single largest category, 3x the size of #2

Where the Real Opportunities Sit: Mapping Scale vs. Monetization



High Users + High Monetization

Core Opportunity

SaaS, Marketing, Analytics

High Users + Low Monetization

Monetization Opportunity

AI, Productivity, Mobile Apps

Low Users + High Monetization

Premium / Niche Opportunity

Customer Support, Marketplace, Education

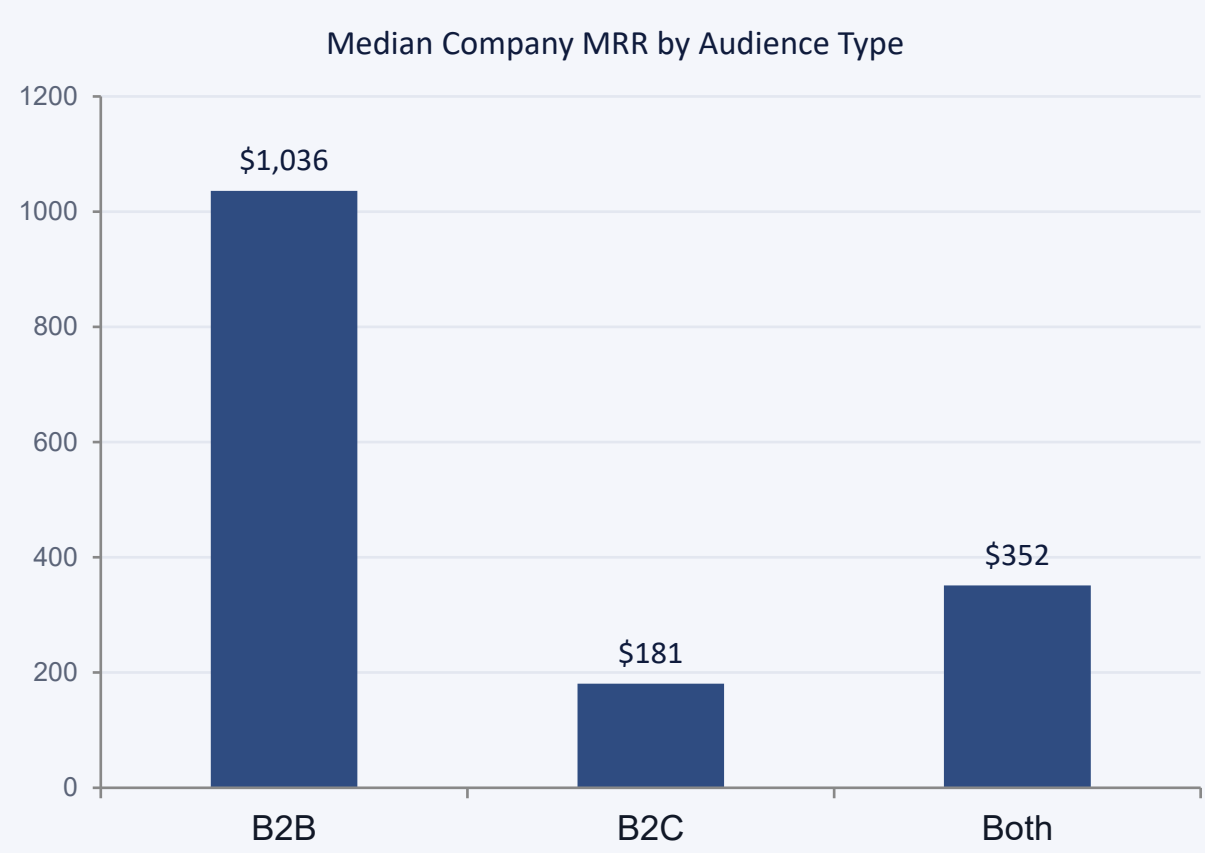
Low Users + Low Monetization

Low Priority

Travel, Real Estate, Design Tools

Bubble size = total category MRR. Left-to-right: AI, SaaS, Education, Marketing, E-comm, Analytics, Social Media, Mobile Apps, Productivity, Customer Support, Marketplace.
Builder Economy Market Intelligence • Snapshot dated 30 Jul 2026

The Single Biggest Lever: B2B Monetizes 5.7x Better Than B2C



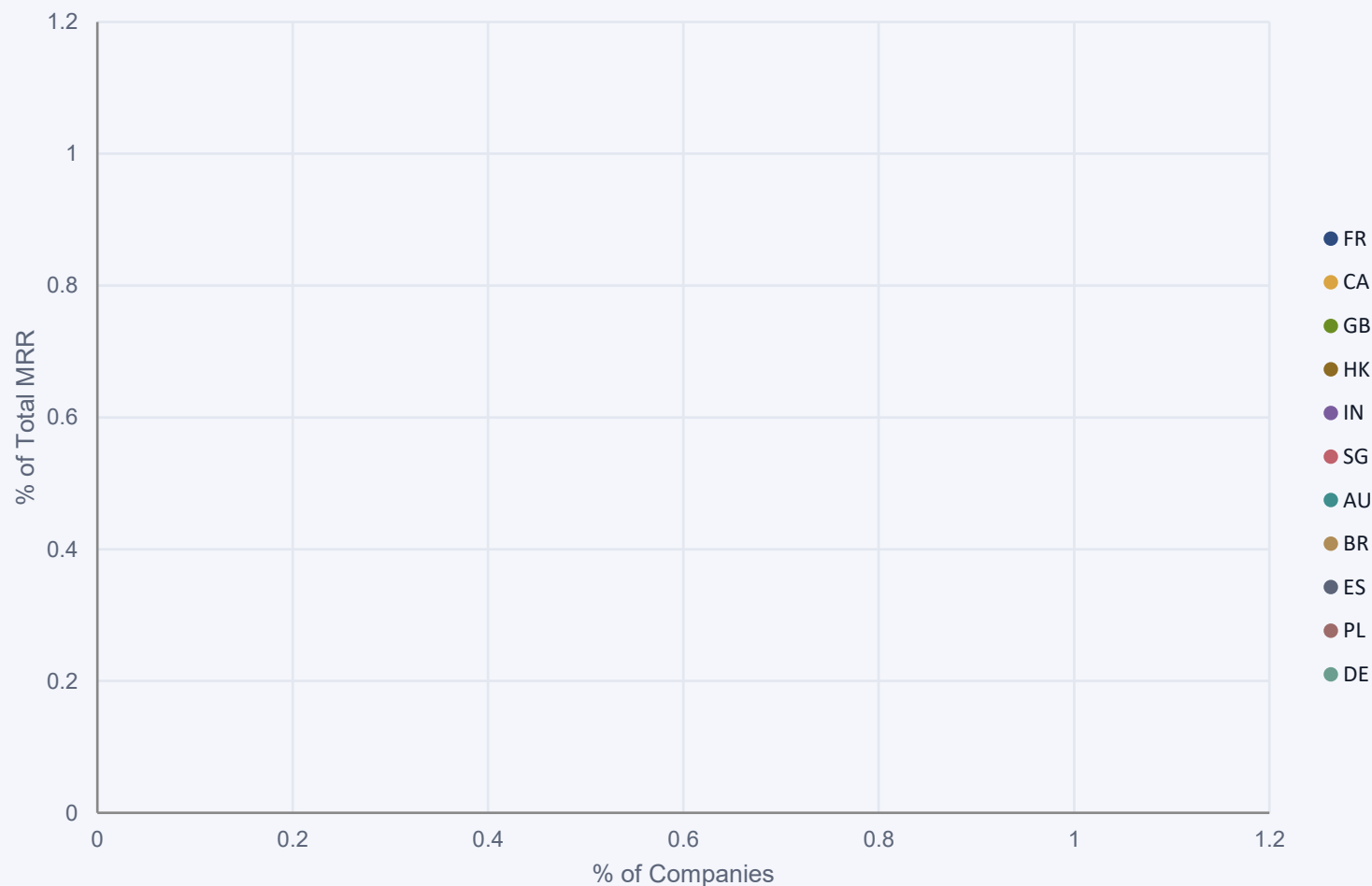
5.7x

B2B median MRR (\$1,036) vs. B2C median MRR (\$181)

Within AI alone, B2B still wins

- B2B AI companies: \$1,357 median MRR
- B2C AI companies: \$277.50 median MRR
- A 4.9x gap — audience type predicts monetization even inside the hottest category.

The US Doesn't Just Have More Companies — It Captures Outsized Value



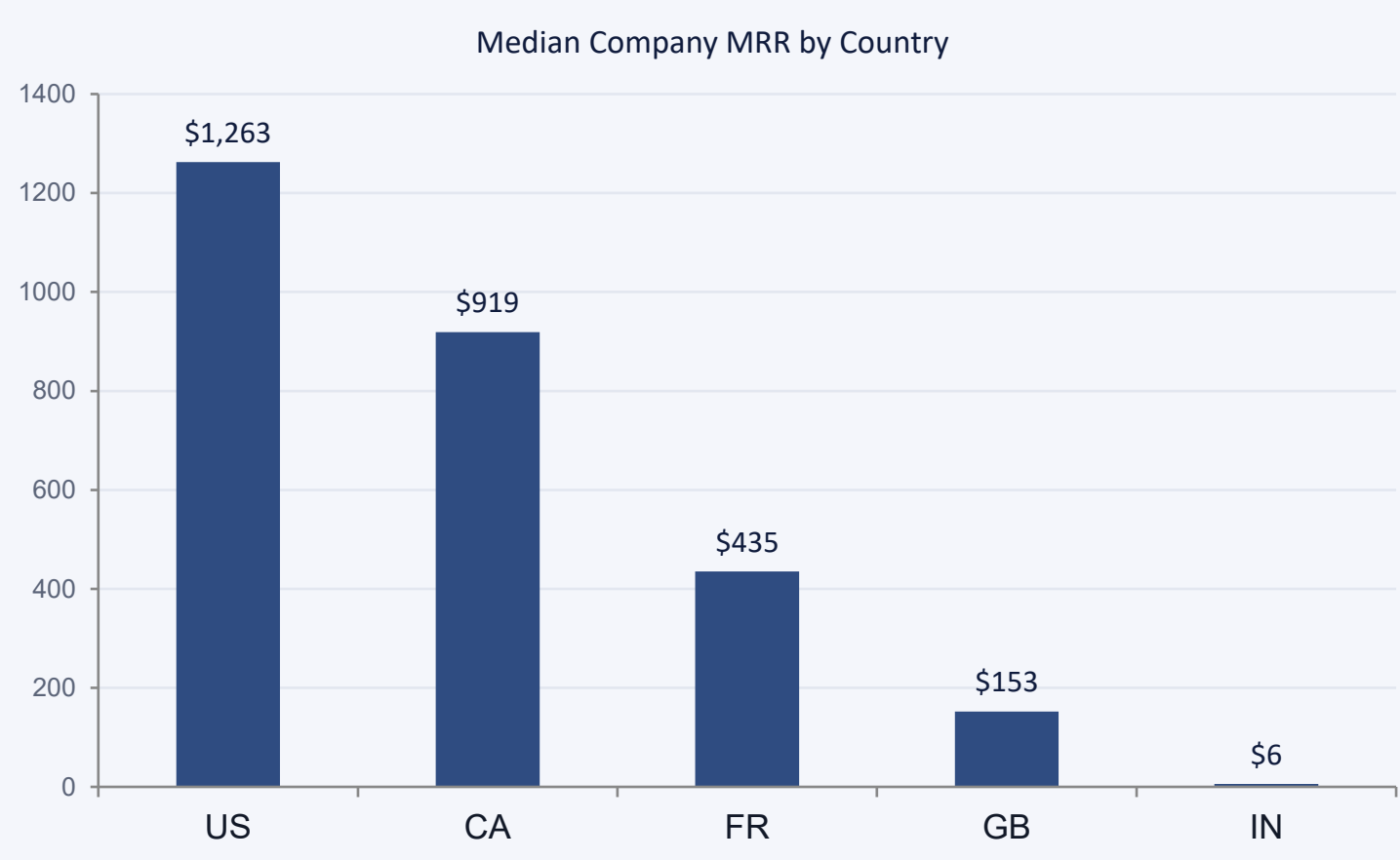
2.1x

The US monetization multiplier

The US holds 34.0% of companies with a known country, but captures 71.3% of all tracked revenue. Points above the diagonal are over-monetizing relative to their scale — the US sits far above it.

France and Canada track close to proportional — the diagonal an efficient market would follow.

Volume Without Value: Markets That Haven't Monetized — Yet



India: Scale, Not Yet Value

- 59 companies — 7.8% of all companies with a known country
- Only 1.5% of total tracked MRR
- Median company MRR: just \$5.97 — effectively unmonetized
- Reads as an opportunity signal, not a proven wedge — worth monitoring, not resourcing today

Where to Play First: A Three-Tier Geographic Roadmap

TIER 1 — PRIORITIZE

- US — 2.1x monetization multiplier
- Singapore — \$2,126 median MRR
- Lithuania — \$13,403 median MRR (small sample, strong signal)

TIER 2 — BUILD SELECTIVELY

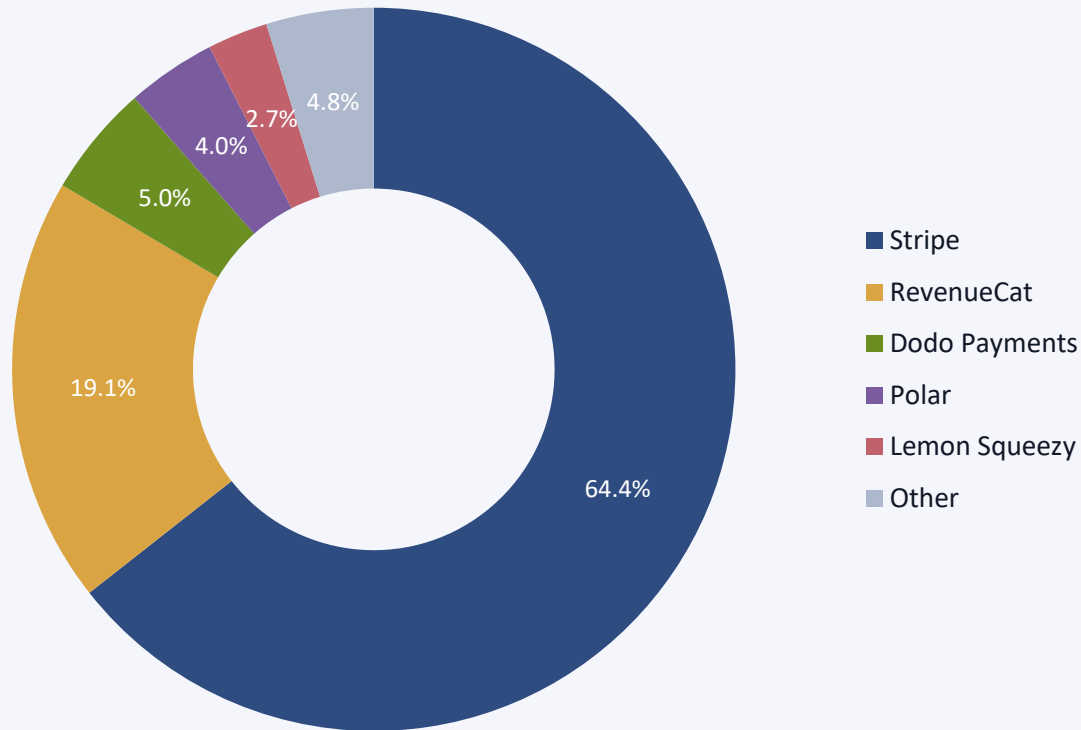
- France — proportional scale & revenue
- United Kingdom — modest under-monetization
- Germany, Canada — stable, in-line performance

TIER 3 — MONITOR

- India — high volume, near-zero monetization
- Turkey — median MRR of just \$22.50
- Other high-count / low-monetization markets

Verified, Not Self-Reported: Why This Data Is Different

Every Listing Traces to a Live Payment-Processor Connection



100%

Of tracked companies have revenue confirmed by a named payment API — not a self-reported figure

Domain authority isn't a substitute for verified traction

Correlation between domain rating and MRR across the dataset is just $r = 0.21$ — weak. SEO strength alone tells you almost nothing about revenue quality, reinforcing why a verified-revenue layer is a distinct, defensible asset.

Beneath the Directory Lies a Deal Room

\$86.8M in acquisition-ready inventory is already visible inside the same verified dataset.

1,000

Companies Tracked

262

Flagged For Sale (26.2%)

\$86.8M

Combined Asking-Price Inventory

3.0x

Median

Asking

Multiple

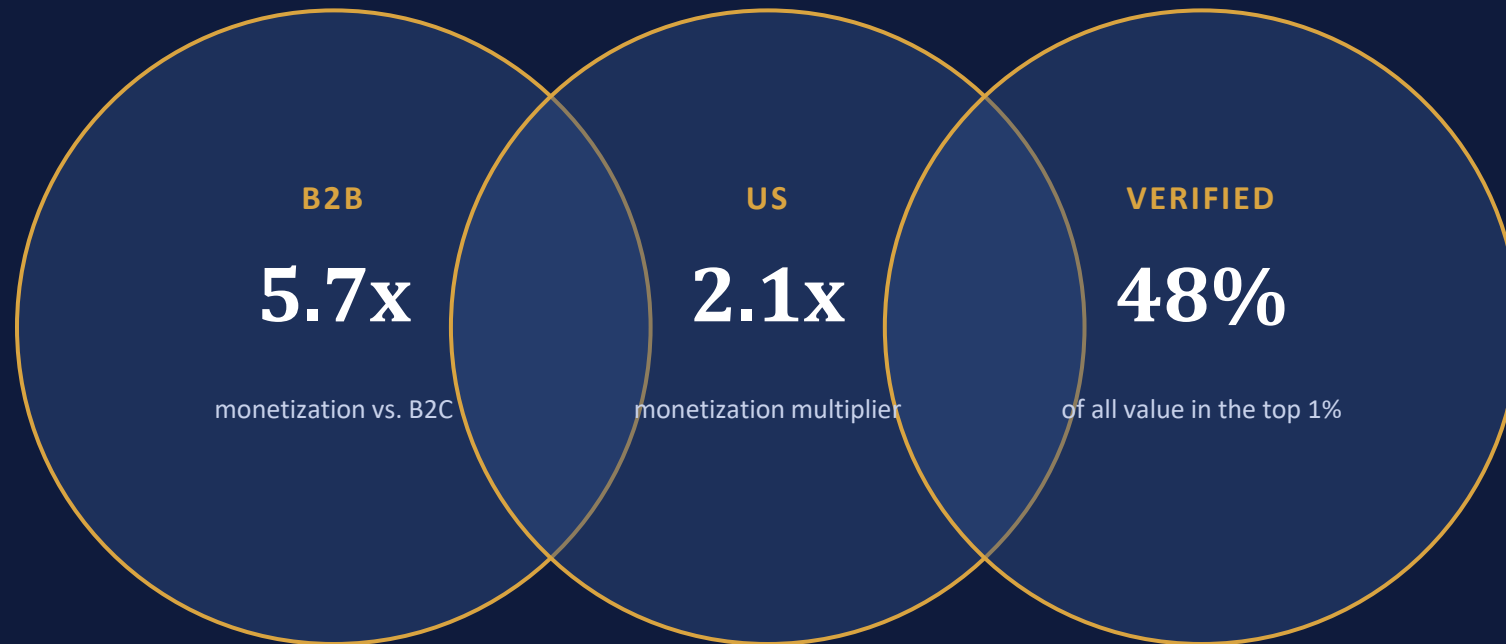
(Trailing

12 Months

MRR)

Median multiple of 3.0x trailing MRR (mean skewed to 9.5x by a handful of high-multiple outliers, up to 9.9x) — evidence of a nascent, still-inefficient micro-M&A market within this startup population.

The Wedge: Verified B2B Businesses in the US



The intersection of these three signals — not a broad-market land grab — is the highest-monetizing, most defensible entry point.

From Wedge to Category-Defining Platform



Every phase is grounded in evidence already established — not speculation.

A Concentrated, Underserved Market — Ready for a Focused Play

100%

Revenue Verified

82%

Of Value in Top 10% of
Companies

5.7x

B2B vs. B2C Monetization Edge

2.1x

US Monetization Multiplier

\$86.8M

Acquisition Inventory Already
Visible

Verified data, extreme value concentration, and a proven B2B/US monetization edge — layered with an already-visible pool of acquisition-ready businesses — point to a clear, defensible entry point in a fast-growing, underserved market.

Key risks: single-date snapshot (no measured growth trend), true TAM beyond this 1,000-company sample not measurable from available data, marketplace conversion and multiple ranges based on a limited, self-selected for-sale subset.